

Philipp Hilbert. *Lead Product Manager, client-side delivery and AI-native product work.*

Positioning, 13 years owning discovery-to-delivery for regulated and complex products, now doing that inside a consulting model.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN

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§ WHY MONKS

Monks builds digital products for clients, which means the PM role carries two jobs at once: being the trusted voice to the client and being the person who keeps the delivery team honest. That combination is exactly what I have done across defence AI, public-sector analytics, and insurance SaaS. The explicit call-out of Claude Code and Codex as daily tools is the part that most agencies would bury in a footnote. Monks puts it in the opening paragraph. *That tells me the product practice here is run by people who actually build, not just manage.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and refactor work
- **GitHub Copilot**, coding assistance across Python and JS
- **Cursor**, editor-integrated AI workflows
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **Framer**, design-heavy prototypes
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, structured deck drafts

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD with Jenkins and GitLab, Dagster, dbt, Kafka, Azure DevOps, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

A two-sided B2B marketplace that takes the headhunter out of construction staffing.

- Matches construction firms with workers directly, with an anonymity-until-payment model protecting both sides until commitment.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one person can run day-to-day operations.
 - Built zero to one alone, with funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.
 - Directly relevant: demonstrates 0-to-1 product thinking, agentic product design, and autonomous delivery in a consulting-style constraint.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MONKS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the delivery team and the client relationship, map the current backlog against the stated business outcome, and identify where the discovery work has and has not been done.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the problem.

Run at least one structured discovery session with the client to surface the competing priorities that are not yet written down, and translate them into clear trade-off options for the team.

Ship and measure.

Take ownership of the roadmap, set the KPIs that will tell us whether the next release actually moved the needle, and start closing the loop between what we built and what the data shows.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Monks team,

I have spent 13 years owning product problems in regulated, high-stakes environments: defence AI at Rohde & Schwarz, national labour-market analytics for the German Federal Employment Agency, B2B insurance SaaS at EMIL Group, and clinical mobile apps. In every case, the hardest part was not writing the roadmap. It was earning enough trust from the client to tell them the honest answer instead of the comfortable one.

That is the job you are describing. The Lead Product Manager role at Monks sits between the client and the delivery team, and the person in that seat has to hold both at once. I know what it costs to get that balance wrong. At EMIL Group, I inherited a delivery organisation where client trust had broken down and senior engineers were leaving. I restructured three lean teams with their own leads, shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week. The fix was not process. It was being clear about what we were actually building and why.

On AI tools: I use Claude Code and Copilot as daily instruments for spec work, in-repo refactors, and edge-case generation. I have built multi-agent workflows in n8n and prototyped front-ends with Lovable and Framer. I am not fluent in these tools as a talking point. I use them to move faster on the discovery and scoping work that usually takes the longest.

The Monks.Flow angle is the part of this role I find most interesting. Helping a client instrument their marketing stack with agentic orchestration is a hard product problem: you have to understand their operational workflow deeply enough to know where an agent loop adds value and where it just adds complexity. That kind of discovery and requirements work is what I do.

I would welcome a conversation about how this fits the team's current pipeline.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Product Manager and Product Owner with 13 years of product ownership in regulated industries: defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance SaaS, healthcare, payments, and retail. I run continuous discovery, turn strategy, user needs, and technical constraints into requirements and a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe). I have a consulting and client-facing background across multiple engagements and am comfortable ramping quickly on unfamiliar domains.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

LEAD PRODUCT MANAGER / PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ,
MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.
- Led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers, putting the team in autonomous control of its own environments, and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures: user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital information system workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from a near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent, and cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to under a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments. POS and forecourt systems in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government. Secure data platform and identity management for Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

- Delivered data structures and identity management for two live government programmes.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance. B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.
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§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers. Built zero to one alone: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise buyers' constraints. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero, taken to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, n8n.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART, PI planning, CI/CD.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, Matomo, MicroStrategy.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, client advisory, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

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